

Sendero Brand Book

Sendero

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Sendero Design System

This file is the source of truth for Sendero's product and marketing design direction. It applies to the marketing app, the authenticated app, Storybook, and the shared `@sendero/ui` package.

Implementation References

- Shared brand tokens: `packages/ui/src/brand/sendero-brand.ts`
- Shared CSS variables: `packages/ui/src/globals.css`
- Storybook brand book: `apps/storybook/stories/brand/BrandBook.stories.tsx`
- Storybook static assets: `apps/storybook/public/brand`
- Design-system brand assets: `packages/ui/brand`

Sendero Brand Book

1. BRAND OVERVIEW

Sendero is an agent-native travel booking platform.

The brand should feel:

- intelligent
- curious
- editorial
- warm
- guided
- premium but approachable

It should not feel like a generic travel app, a chat product, or a cold corporate SaaS tool. The visual identity should suggest **discovery, planning, route intelligence, and travel perspective**.

2. CORE BRAND IDEA

Brand metaphor: Sendero is a smart travel guide with taste.

The identity combines:

- travel exploration

- wayfinding
- editorial charm
- AI-assisted guidance

The system should feel like a modern travel companion with a slightly literary, observant, map-room sensibility.

3. LOGO SYSTEM

Primary Platform Icon

Binocular mark

This is the core platform icon.

It combines:

- a **binocular silhouette** for discovery, planning, and search
- a **star** in the left lens for direction, navigation, and intelligence
- a **mountain line** in the right lens for destination, horizon, and travel context

What The Icon Communicates

- seeing ahead
- curated discovery
- travel intelligence
- perspective
- movement toward a destination

Why It Works

The binocular shape is:

- travel-native without being generic
- distinct from messaging or aviation icons
- flexible across product, app, deck, and editorial surfaces
- simple enough to scale well

4. BRAND PERSONALITY

Thoughtful

Not loud, not gimmicky, not trend-chasing.

Elegant

A refined editorial taste, not luxury-for-luxury's-sake.

Adventurous

There is movement, curiosity, and a sense of horizon.

Intelligent

The AI layer should feel useful and subtle, not robotic.

Human

Slight imperfection, texture, and warmth matter.

5. VISUAL STYLE PRINCIPLES

Core Look

- loose vermillion linework
- visible grain
- subtle distressed print texture
- slightly imperfect registration
- hand-drawn editorial sensibility
- minimalist forms
- calm spacing
- light warm backgrounds

Avoid

- shiny startup gradients
- glassmorphism
- generic tech blue as default
- overly sterile geometric perfection
- icons that resemble Telegram, paper planes, or chat apps
- overly literal airplane or travel cliches

6. COLOR SYSTEM

Primary Color

Vermillion

#D65438

Use for:

- primary icon
- hero branding
- headline brand moments
- editorial brand surfaces
- key product identity moments

This is the main emotional color of the brand. It carries warmth, visibility, and distinction.

Supporting Icon Colors

Midnight

#1F2A44

Use for:

- dark mode
- formal presentations
- trust-heavy surfaces
- documentation
- neutral product contexts

Tone: grounded, reliable, intelligent.

Sea

#0F7C82

Use for:

- travel operations
- map-related features
- system accents
- product moments needing freshness or utility

Tone: calm, navigational, capable.

Sand

#B6844E

Use for:

- editorial moments
- hospitality contexts
- warm supporting applications
- softer secondary branding

Tone: warm, cultured, understated.

7. COLOR USAGE GUIDANCE

Default Hierarchy

1. **Vermillion** = main brand expression
2. **Midnight** = trusted/system expression
3. **Sea** = functional travel expression
4. **Sand** = warm editorial expression

Rule

The alternate colors support the system. They do **not** replace the primacy of vermillion.

8. ICON USAGE

Use The Icon When

- space is limited
- the full wordmark is unnecessary
- the platform needs a recognizable shorthand
- app/product surfaces need a compact identity mark

Use The Wordmark + Icon When

- presenting the full brand
- landing pages
- pitch decks
- brand introductions

- external-facing communications

9. CLEAR SPACE

Always leave breathing room around the icon.

Minimum clear space: at least **25% of the icon's width** on all sides.

Do not crowd it with:

- text
- buttons
- borders
- other logos
- busy illustrations

The icon works best when it has room to sit calmly.

10. MINIMUM SIZE

Digital

- minimum: **24 px height**
- preferred: **64 px and above**

Print

- minimum: **12 mm height**

Below these sizes, texture may be reduced if necessary, but the shape must stay intact.

11. CONSTRUCTION PRINCIPLES

The icon should preserve these elements:

- rounded binocular body
- balanced two-lens structure
- star in left lens
- mountain line in right lens
- single-color outline logic
- simple internal detail

Do not alter the internal symbols casually.

12. DO / DON'T

Do

- use a single solid color
- keep proportions intact
- place on calm, high-contrast backgrounds
- preserve the mark exactly
- use it with restraint and confidence

Don't

- stretch or squash the icon
- add drop shadows
- add gradients
- put it on noisy backgrounds
- over-outline it
- rotate it arbitrarily
- replace the star or mountain with random symbols

13. BACKGROUND APPLICATIONS

Best Background Types

- warm off-white
- soft cream
- muted neutrals
- deep midnight fields
- calm pale map tones
- lightly textured editorial surfaces

Avoid Backgrounds That Are

- too busy
- low contrast
- hyper-saturated
- glossy or synthetic
- visually competitive with the mark

14. TYPOGRAPHY DIRECTION

The typography should feel:

- editorial
- elegant
- legible
- slightly literary
- premium but not ornate

Best Fit

- serif for the main wordmark/headlines
- restrained supporting sans or simple serif for product/body use

The overall balance should feel like **travel magazine meets intelligent product company**.

15. ILLUSTRATION DIRECTION

Illustration should support the brand, not overpower it.

Preferred Traits

- hand-drawn linework
- path motifs
- stamp/seal references
- route logic
- subtle explorer cues
- horizon imagery
- print texture
- limited palette

Avoid

- cartoon overload
- literal AI robots
- overly futuristic UI imagery
- excessive detail at small sizes

16. BRAND TONE IN PRODUCT

Sendero should look like it:

- understands travel deeply
- reduces chaos
- guides you with taste
- sees possibilities before you do

It should feel more like a **trusted editorial travel guide with intelligence** than a generic booking engine.

17. POSITIONING SUMMARY

Sendero is an intelligent travel brand built around guidance, perspective, and discovery.

Its identity should feel warm, distinctive, editorial, and quietly capable.

The binocular icon is the clearest expression of this idea because it represents:

- looking ahead
- seeing clearly
- choosing better routes
- finding meaningful destinations

18. QUICK USAGE CHEAT SHEET

Primary icon color: Vermillion #D65438

Alt 1: Midnight #1F2A44

Alt 2: Sea #0F7C82

Alt 3: Sand #B6844E

Primary icon meaning: discovery + wayfinding + destination intelligence

Best use cases for the binocular icon:

- app icon
- favicon
- nav bar mark
- social avatar
- onboarding screens
- product surfaces
- travel ops views
- deck cover accent

19. ONE-LINE INTERNAL BRAND RULE

Sendero should feel like an intelligent explorer's mark, not a generic travel app logo.